Jerry(Jiarui) Zhang

(213) 561-9849 jiaruizhang0613[AT]gmail.com saccharomycetes.github.io/ Los Angeles, CA 90007

Education

University of Southern California **August 2022–Present**
Ph.D. in Computer Science, Advisor: Willie Neiswanger, GPA: 3.78/4.00 *Los Angeles, USA*

Tsinghua University **August 2018–June 2022**
Bachelor of Science, Electrical Engineering, GPA: 3.64/4.00 *Beijing, China*

Publications (* denotes equal contribution)

Google Scholar

- **J Zhang***, M Tao*, S Wang*, O Liu, X Ma, W Neiswanger. *'An Exam for Active Observers'*, arXiv 2026. [Paper] [Project]
- **J Zhang**, M Khayatkhoei, P Chhikara, F Ilievski. *'MLLMs Know Where to Look: Training-free Perception of Small Visual Details with Multimodal LLMs'*, ICLR 2025
- **J Zhang**, O Liu, T Yu, J Hu, W Neiswanger. *'Euclid: Supercharging Multimodal LLMs with Synthetic High-Fidelity Visual Descriptions'*, In submission, 2025.
- **J Zhang***, J Hu*, M Khayatkhoei, F Ilievski, M Sun. *'Exploring Perceptual Limitations of Multimodal LLMs on Small Visual Objects'*, TMLR 2026.
- Y Jiang*, **J Zhang***, K Sun*, Z Sourati, K Ahrabian, K Ma, F Ilievski, J Pujara. *'MARVEL: Multidimensional Abstraction and Reasoning through Visual Evaluation and Learning'*, NeurIPS D&B Track 2024.
- **J Zhang**. *'Guided Profile Generation Improves Personalization with LLMs'*, EMNLP 2024.
- K Ahrabian, Z Sourati, K Sun, **J Zhang**, Y Jiang, F Morstatter, J Pujara. *'The curious case of nonverbal abstract reasoning with multi-modal large language models'*, COLM 2024.
- **J Zhang**, F Ilievski, K Ma, A Kollaa, J Francis, A Oltramari. *'A Study of Situational Reasoning for Traffic Understanding'*, KDD 2023.
- P Chhikara, **J Zhang**, F Ilievski, J Francis, K Ma. *'Knowledge-enhanced agents for interactive text games'*, K-Cap, 2023. (Best Student Paper Award)
- **J Zhang**, F Ilievski, K Ma, J Francis, A Oltramari. *'A Study of Zero-shot Adaptation with Commonsense Knowledge'*, AKBC 2022.
- X Yi, **J Zhang**, W Li, X Wang, X Xie. *'Clickbait Detection via Contrastive Variational Modelling of Text and Label'*, IJCAI 2022.

Experience

University of Southern California **August 2022–Present**
Graduate Student Researcher *Los Angeles, USA*
- High-fidelity data training, geometry understanding and low-level visual perception for multimodal LLMs and AI-for-Science.
- Exploring multimodal LLMs' self-improvement on visual perception ability.

Google Cloud **August 2026–Present**
Research Intern *Sunnyvale, USA*
- Researching multimodal AI agents and visual-feedback systems for generating and evaluating visual artifacts.

Google DeepMind **May 2025–August 2025**
Student Researcher *Los Angeles, USA*
- Building challenging and diagnostic benchmarks for multimodal large language and reasoning models.

Amazon Alexa AI **May 2023–August 2023**
Applied Scientist Intern *Bellevue, USA*
- Personalization enhancement with large language models on both efficacy and efficiency by step-wise self-optimization.

Programming

Python, Shell Scripting, LaTeX, Prompt Engineering

Teaching

Teaching Assistant for USC CSCI 572 **Spring 2024, Fall 2025**
Teaching Assistant for USC DSCI 552 **Fall 2024, Summer 2024**

Updated on 9/14/2026